

3x5 HEARTBREAKER

A Bonkers Dungeon Game
on Index Cards

This is a complete OSR Dungeon ruleset
with strategic depth & bonkers energy.

I made it so GMs could play with their
kids. Loose enough to inhabit the kid
energy of playing pretend, but with
enough rules structure to keep the
parent from going absolutely insane.

It's also great for co-worker lunch break
games.

It's dead simple to convert old modules
and play on the fly. Enjoy!

CHARACTER CREATION

1. Describe your character with **two words** and
a **who**, like "Space Knight who can't go home."
2. Choose your best **Ability**. Color in the hearts.
You always have 1 Advantage on that roll type..
3. Write a signature weapon or item under gear.
4. Roll 3d12 for starting Coin.
5. Choose 1 **Feature**.
6. Ask the ref how many Might to mark.

Bonkers: 10 | Gritty: 5 | Horror: 2

NAME:

Description:

BODY:



MIND:



SPIRIT:



**Armor. **

Might.



XP.

Gear

Magic

ABILITIES

BODY. Strength, Dexterity, physical skill.
All Physical Combat Rolls are Body.

MIND. Intelligence, Wisdom, skill at
learning. All Spellcasting rolls are Mind.

SPIRIT. Charisma, grit, connection to
mysterious powers. All Saves are Spirit.

ROLLING DICE

When the outcome is uncertain and
failure has consequences, roll.

Ref sets an **Ability** (Body, Mind, Spirit)
and a Difficulty Number (**DN**): the
number of **d12s** you start with.

0	Extreme
2	Risky
4+	It just works (no roll)

Success. Any die ≥ 9
Opposed Rolls. Most Successes wins.
*3d6. To use d6s, make 5-6 a success.

DIS / ADVANTAGES

Advantage = +1 die
Disadvantage = -1 die

ADV is anything that helps.
DIS is anything that hurts.
They stack, so 2 ADV + 1 DIS = 1 ADV.

COMBAT

Take turns, starting with the youngest player.
Attacks. Body Rolls (Risky: DN 2), $\pm$ DIS/ADV

Each Success = 1 Hit
1 Hit = 1 Damage (usually)

DAMAGE

Each point of Damage is a *Heartbreaker*. Cross off
(break) one ♥. You have 1 Disadvantage on that
roll type for each broken ♥. Mark 1 XP.

Body ♥: broken by physical harm
Mind ♥: broken by mental harm
Spirit ♥: broken by magical harm

You can prevent Damage with *Saves* and *Armor*.

BROKEN-HEARTED

An ability with 3 broken ♥s is *Broken-Hearted*.

Broken-Hearted Body. You're dead.

Broken-Hearted Mind. You're stupefied: can't
think, speak or use magic. You can follow simple
instructions from people you trust.

Broken-Hearted Spirit. The lights are on but no
one's home; you can't take actions. You might
become a mindless minion of whatever did it.

HEALING

Might. 1 pt / Hour of Rest
♥s. 1 of each type / night of rest
Magic Healing. Always costs 2 Might / ♥
Magic can't heal Might.

MIGHT

A combo of luck, health, grit and mojo.
Spend 1 Might to

- Re-roll up to 3 dice from any roll
- Roll a Save
- Use a Power

SPELLCASTING

Spells are 2 words, and do what they
say. They don't do *one* thing.

You need 2 hands free to cast spells.
They take up 1 line each under Magic.

- Say what you want the spell to do
- Ref sets the difficulty, 0-4.
- Roll Mind. If you succeed, it works.
If you fail, *something* happens, but
not what you intended.

Spells that do damage directly do
1 Damage / Success.

POWERS

Powers do something specific. Make
them up! Ref decides if they're allowed.

Powers cost 1 Might to use.
Extreme uses may cost more.
They take up 2 lines each under Magic.
(More detail? Use another 3x5 card.)

Powers that do damage directly do the
same damage as regular Attacks.

MONSTERS

Power = 0-4 The number of dice a monster always starts rolls with. Usually have 1 ADV on one roll type.

Might = Power x2

Damage. 1 or more Damage / Hit

Special. May also have *Spells* or *Powers*, or Extraordinary Abilities.

Morale. At 0 Might, Roll Spirit (Risky: DN2). If no successes, run away or surrender.

Hearts. Like Characters, Monsters have **3 ♥s** each in **Body, Mind** and **Spirit**.

No Saves. Monsters don't roll Saves. They pay 1 Might to block 1 Damage.

Converting Monsters from other dungeon-games: **Power Level = HD**

ELECTRIC MEDUSA

Power Level. 3 (Rolls 3d12)

Might. 6

Advantage. Mind

Extraordinary. *Electric Gaze.* Meeting the gaze: break 1 Body ♥.

Spell. Screaming Snakes. (No Roll unless a DIS: P3 + ADV Mind)

Carries. A whip.

Wants. Revenge.

MONSTER ABILITIES

Pseudopods	Replicating
Sticky	Skeletal
Flying	Saddening
Destroys Gear	Liquifying
Fear	Incomprehensible
Petrifying	Absurd
Transmuting	Gigantic
Infecting	Invisible
Maddening	Hideous
Poisoning	Royal
Flaming	Whimsical
Silencing	Ghostly

MAGIC TREASURE TYPES

Scroll	Any Spell, 1 use
Wand	Any Spell, 4 uses
Potion	Any Power, 1 use
Ring	Any Power, 4 uses
Weapon	+1 Damage
Armor	Occupies 1/2 Gear slots
Magic Gear	Living rope, etc
Scrying Mirror	See through another's eyes

EXPERIENCE

You gain XP when you fail, when you're hurt, when you find treasure, and when you achieve quests. The ref awards it.

XP GUIDELINES

1XP / Failed Roll

1XP / Heartbreaker

2XP / Treasure Find

5XP / Quest Completed

At 10XP, choose a *Feature*. Reset your XP to 0.

FEATURES

Not today, Death. When at 0 Might and in danger: on your turn, roll Spirit (Risky: DN 2). On a success, gain 1 Might.

Powerful. Gain a Power. (Must have 2 free lines under Magic.)

Learned. Learn a Spell. (Must have 1 free line under Magic.)

Mighty. Gain 3 Might. (Max 20)

Dangerous. When you do Damage, do 1 extra Damage.

Tough. When you are hit, take 1 less Damage. (Minimum 1 / Hit)

Hauler. You can use free lines under Magic as extra Gear Slots.

SPELLS

Make up your own! You should be able to cast the same spell many ways.

Air Walk	Shimmering Wall
Protect Other	Big Hammer
Slip Foot	Body Swap
Fire Hands	Destroy Magic
Elastic Body	Electric Breath
Ice Vision	Floating Hand
Living Fog	Magic Arrow
Magic Rope	Smoke Form
Healing Touch	Immovable Object
Terrible Speed	Stone Rain
Wizard Lock	Cat's Leap
Horrible Wind	Invisible Cape

POWERS

Make up your own! Powers should be limited, specific, and fun. They should not reference a game mechanic. Ref decides what's allowed.

Good Powers

- I turn into a dire wolf.
- I teleport a short distance: BANG!
- I know people everywhere.
- I sing to stones, and they sing back.
- I transfer my urine to someone else.

Bad Powers

- I turn into anything I want!
- I am invincible!
- I know everything!
- I get infinite Might!

GEAR

You have 10 gear slots, one per line. Most items take up 1 slot. Some take up more (as Armor does). Some might bundle: 10 candles / slot, etc.

PRICE BENCHMARKS

Mundane Items	5c
Complex / High Quality Items	20c
Exotic / Specialty Items	100c

ARMOR

Blocking. You can use armor to block a hit. It blocks *all* of the damage from that hit.

Broken. When at 0, it's useless until repaired.

Armor. 1 Hit Blocked = 1 Gear Slot & 100c.

Repair. Cost to repair 1 Hit: 50c

Leather	2 hits, 2 gear slots, 200c
Chain	4 hits, 4 gear slots, 400c
Plate	6 hits, 6 gear slots, 600c
Shield	3 hits, 2 gear slots, 50c & occupies a hand. (No Spells.)
<i>Optional</i>	<i>DIS on Spells if Armor > 5</i>

SAVES

When you try to avoid harm, roll a Risky **Spirit** Roll. This is a **Save**. It costs 1 Might.

Damage. Reduce Damage by 1 for each Success.

Magic. Ref decides the precise effect. Guidelines:

1 Success. You lessen the effect.

2+ Successes. You avoid it.

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Design notes:

Mechanically, it's built around balancing 3 key resources: Might, Gear Slots, and Advantages.

Spiritually, it's about enabling the Bonkers style of play you rocked before you really understood the rules.

Bonkers GM Style. Get weird, say yes to madcap ideas, and make creativity and decisions matter.

Tension Loop. At 10 Might, you're king of a zany world. At 5, every decision you make matters. At 2, you are running scared.

Get ye into that darkness, ye mad fools!

This is a shorthand guide. For complete rules and more 3x5 card nerd stuff:
3x5Arcana.com



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